

AMENDMENT:

The following questions and answers are provided to all interested Proponents. Where possible, similar questions asked by multiple proponents were consolidated into a single question.

Question 1: How interconnected are the GOS ministries in regard to their IT.

Response: Information Technology Division (ITD) supports up to 17 ministries in executive government. Interconnection between each ministry is present in our one government approach.

Question 2: Are future projects from this RFSQ going to be a collaboration between ITD and the ministries that need services?

Response: A bit of both. For example: if a ministry is in need of a data architect ITD would procure for the ministry. ITD provides one point of contact for the ministries.

Question 3: What are your current data warehousing capabilities?

Response: The current data warehousing is managed and delivered as a service through ITD and our technology platforms provider. Warehousing is predominantly built with the IBM Infosphere products and DB2 is data base backing the data warehouse.

Question 4: What do you use for ETL tools?

Response: Enterprise platform uses the IBM Infosphere suite. The reporting tool is IBM Cognos, however GOS has the capability of using Power BI. The Enterprise GIS platform is an on-premise deployment of the enterprise GIS solution from ESRI. We use SAFE Software's FME tools and vendor supplied solutions to design and build ETL to automate and improve workflows for spatial data.

Question 5: With the existing solution, what are your gaps?

Response: We have an existing vendor in place to modernize and support the toolset. GOS is aware of some gaps, the top areas currently being considered include improved data masking, data cataloguing, data quality management and real-time access to data.

Question 6: Data Governance, ETL loading from what? I.e.: Flat files.

Response: Currently there are multiple ministries with different business applications resulting in different data sources such as DB2, Oracle, SQL Server, GOS also has API based connections.

Question 7: Have you considered migration to cloud?

Response: Cloud is a consideration, GOS currently has a presence in both the cloud and on prem. GOS is working with current service providers to determine when moving to cloud is appropriate.

Question 8: Who is your cloud provider(s)?

Response: Microsoft Azure is currently part of the formally supported enterprise services. There are also some third-party systems that use Amazon Web Services and GOS currently has some cloud services running in Oracle Cloud. Additional cloud services are being reviewed.

Question 9: Can you talk about 2 year and 5-year goals?

Response: GOS envisions being seen as a leader providing better services to our citizens, businesses and industries. The dynamically changing landscape is driving the need for system enhancement. GOS is looking to grow their service offering while maintaining current state and enhance as GOS works towards modern analytics. This includes promoting data driven decision making.

Question 10: Do you have any POCs in place to modernize?

Response: Nothing currently is underway.

Question 11: Would modernization fall under this RFSQ?

Response: The RFP together with the RFSQ provides the approach to the modernization of the platform and data practices.

Question 12: Are you looking for support for core databases?

Response: We do have a team in place for support and through this RFSQ are looking for additional services to complement and extend our in-house capabilities.

Question 13: Is GOS looking to segregate ministry data and security as part of the requirements?

Response: GOS currently has segregation in place.

Question 14: Are you open to new software and upgrades?

Response: The scope of the RFP is intended to include the existing solution. As GOS becomes aware of needs and changes, we are open to bringing new technology in. GOS does need to ensure as any change is implemented the workflow is maintained. This RFSQ is part of a bigger envisioned operating model (refer to the diagram and discussion in the RFSQ for additional details). The RFP is focused on the technology platform sustainment and evolution. This RFSQ is intended to provide additional consulting capabilities. While technology is part of the equation, there are non-technology areas such as governance, culture and practices as well. New technologies would need to be coordinated with GOS, the platform provider and the ministries.

Question 15: Would this be open to crown corporations to leverage?

Response: Language has been included for their ability to leverage.

Question 16: Can you explain local knowledge and what GOS is looking for?

Response: Refer to Section D.2. Knowledge of public service organizations, ideally Saskatchewan, or other Canadian provincial entities would be beneficial to note in your response.

Question 17: How does the scope of work requested in this RFSQ align with RFP Information Management Platform recently issued?

Response: The focus of the RFP is to maintain and sustain the existing platform and services, along with identifying gaps and working towards modernization. Within that, GOS envisions additional work to fall into the 6 areas identified in the RFSQ. The RFSQ is to help GOS with resources and to provide the ability to acquire these in a timely manner.

Question 18: Can a vendor respond to and potentially be successful on all 6 categories?

Response: Yes, a vendor can be considered for any or all of the 6 categories.

Question 19: Where is the most effort or focus areas of the 6 categories?

Response: GOS is not sure where the initial focus will be. GOS recognizes gaps in our tool offering and as a result business transformation is potentially needed. Several ministries are looking for support moving from aging tools to newer tool(s).

Question 20: Do you see policy work that might need occur?

Response: Yes, in response to the responsible use of AI, consideration is needed. GOS requires a framework.

Question 21: If you are selected as a qualified vendor in the categories, what is the contract/bidding process? Are the qualified vendors required to submit a formal proposal?

Response: Each project leveraging the RFSQ will post a competition to the pre-qualified list. The amount of work required for a proposal will depend on the complexity of the project and details required. That is, a short-term engagement may not need as comprehensive of a response as a longer-term engagement. It will be situation dependent.

Question 22: Are you open to offsite resources?

Response: As long as the mandatory requirements and alignment to Appendix G – Information Security are met, the Service Provider can propose the delivery model that aligns with the requirements of the RFSQ and subsequent competitions. For proposed support resources that reside outside of Canada, specific and detailed descriptions of how the mandatory security requirements can be met will be a critical part of your response. Support will be required 7/24.

Question 23: Do you have projects in mind that would be accessing the RFSQ? How much do you see multiple business units advancing one capability?

Response: GOS has a one government approach, however each ministry is in a different place on their analytics journey. Analytic success is tied directly into business outcomes. The ministries will, however, work together to define the standards.

Question 24: What is the data governance/ management frameworks that are in place?

Response: The enterprise data governance framework is in the concept stage and will need to be formalized. Some ministries have established data governance within the bounds of their organization. The intention is to incorporate/extend the enterprise data governance framework within the overall IT governance framework currently being implemented.

Question 25: Are there any data catalogs/ metadata management tools currently in place?

Response: Some ministries are using basic approaches, some use data modeling tools. We would look to further define "enterprise" tools with the winning proponent of the RFP process.

Question 26: What are the current master data management practices and/or tools currently in place?

Response: There is no master data management initiative or tools in place.

Question 27: How is data quality managed, tracked and reported?

Response: Data quality is currently managed by each individual ministry. An enterprise tool is not in place but has been highlighted as a possible service to add to the technology platform.

Question 28: Are you open to team arrangements?

Response: It would depend on the engagement and the specific opportunity, however GOS is open to any proposal submitted.

Question 29: Do you see business transformation Organizational Change Management (OCM) as being stand alone to projects from the RFSQ or being completed with the RFP?

Response: OCM is critical, GOS has different organizations at different maturity levels and envision this to be a part of both the transformation that is taking place as part of the RFP and projects from the RFSQ.

Question 30: Question D.4.2 requests the proponents to indicate "experience working within a multi-vendor environment to achieve common outcomes". Can you please define "vendor" in the context of this question?

Response: A vendor can be any non-GOS organization that is providing products or services in the data management domain.

Question 31: In Section F - Response Guidelines on page 26/32 of the RFSQ, it states "Each Response should include a Submission Form (Appendix B)". Can you please confirm this was supposed to refer to appendix **D** and not appendix B.

Response: Correct, this is a typo. Appendix D is the Submission form.

Question 32: Besides experience in Microsoft Power BI solutions, is GOS looking for experience in other Microsoft offerings such as SharePoint Online and Microsoft Purview?

Response: GOS is interested in proponent familiarity with any Microsoft products associated with information and data management.

END OF AMMENDMENT